

RESIDENCE LIFE TRAINING FALL 2025

INTERNATIONAL TOMMIES

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PRESENTERS



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OUTLINE

Who are the
international students
of St. Thomas?

Why do international
students come to St.
Thomas?

How do international
students come to St.
Thomas?

How can you help
international students?



WHO ARE THE INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS?

UNIVERSITY OF
St.Thomas

489

TOTAL CURRENT
INTERNATIONAL
POPULATION

238

UNDERGRADUATE

251

GRADUATE, LAW, AND
PROFESSIONAL

TM

WHO ARE THE INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS?

They come from
many different
regions around the
world

They may have
already been living
in the U.S. for
quite some time

They may need
extra support at
times

They may already
be well adjusted to
life in the U.S.

SHOUT OUT THE STEPS IN ORDER OF HOW INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS GET HERE

A. Receive Form I-20 "Certificate of Eligibility for Nonimmigrant Students"

B. Schedule an appointment for a student visa

C. Pay the I-901 SEVIS Fee (\$350)

D. Apply to a university that has been approved by government

E. Maintain a full course of study while at school

F. Arrive in the United States

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WHAT INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS MAY EXPERIENCE

Language barriers (verbal & nonverbal)

Homesickness & lifestyle change

Academic expectations

A new identity

Small/no social network

HOW CAN YOU HELP?



- Make an effort to get to know international students
- Make an effort to make them feel included on the floor
- Think about them when planning floor events
- Help them to understand U.S. customs & culture when possible
- Be a friend
- Be understanding

"Take time to connect with international students to understand their challenges.
This could start conversations about things that may be on the student's mind like where to buy good winter jackets or good places to eat around St. Paul."

"My RA was also an international student. She was always telling me about opportunities and why they would be good for me. She's talked to me about programs like Aquinas Scholars and jobs like being a Resident Advisor. It always felt like she wanted the best for me. I loved that she took the time to do that as it made me feel cared for."

WHAT CAN YOU DO?



WE ARE HERE TO HELP!

**The Office of International Students & Scholars (OISS)
is open Monday - Friday from 8:00am – 4:30pm**

We are located in MHC 212 (2nd Floor)

**Send us an email at oiiss@stthomas.edu or
call 651-962-6650**

Instagram: [@oiiss_stthomas](https://www.instagram.com/oiiss_stthomas)

A large, light gray watermark of the University of Cambridge crest is centered in the background. The crest features an open book at the top, a shield in the middle, and a sunburst at the bottom.

QUESTIONS?

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